The 6:15

MONDAY · AUGUST 10, 2026 NO. 2

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Mon 8/10	13-wk & 26-wk T-bill auctions
Wed 8/12	July CPI (BLS, 8:30a); Cisco earnings AMC — cons. EPS $1.17, rev $16.83B
Thu 8/13	July PPI (BLS); jobless claims; Applied Materials earnings AMC — cons. EPS $3.39, rev $9.01B
Fri 8/14	July retail sales (Census); UMich sentiment, prelim
Sun 8/17	30-yr Treasury bond auction
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision

OPEC+ full ministerial/JMMC: no date confirmed within this window; last full ministerial was June 7.

METRICS · ~6:00A ET MON 8/10 UNLESS NOTED

Brent (ICE, front)	$84.39, +$0.84 / +1.0% — off last week's >7% drop
WTI (NYMEX, front)	$78.77, +$0.60 / +0.75%
Brent–WTI spread	$5.62
UST 2Y/10Y/30Y	4.25% / 4.22% / 5.17% **(30Y as of 8/5, stale)**
DXY	99.67, -0.36%
S&P / Nasdaq-100 fut.	+0.13% / +0.25%; Dow fut. -0.02%
VIX	14.90, -1.65% (Fri cash close)
Gold (spot)	$4,399.70, +2.33%
Nikkei 225 / HSI	66,970.22 +2.1% / 25,904.94 +0.9% (Mon close)
DAX / FTSE / CAC	**not confirmed as of press time**
Retail gas, natl. avg.	$4.0121/gal (AAA, as of 8/9)

Rates/FX/futures as of ~6:00A ET Mon; equity index levels are Friday 8/7's cash close unless marked Mon close. UST 30Y last confirmed 8/5; treat as stale.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 162 (straits.live, as of 10:23 UTC 8/10)

Transits vs. baseline	2 vessels on 8/2 vs. 73/day pre-crisis (Oxford/IMF PortWatch, AIS snapshot)
Weekly transits	84 total, wk of 7/27–8/2, up from 45 prior wk (Lloyd's List Intelligence, >10,000 dwt vessels)
Non-Iranian-linked	52 transits, up from 28; ~25% via untracked Omani "dark" corridor
Strikes	0 confirmed new in 24h; 2 ships struck + 1 attempt via Omani route since 8/1 (Lloyd's List)
War-risk premium	3–10% of hull value vs. 0.25% pre-war; ~$10.0M to insure one VLCC, ~30x (straits.live)
Stranded vessels	~65 new entrants stranded since MoU collapse, plus 70+ stranded since 2/28; mainstream Gulf tanker count fell from 160+ to 29 during the Jun–Jul ceasefire

Methodology note: PortWatch's AIS snapshot, Lloyd's List's weekly >10,000-dwt count, and straits.live's premium/closure tracker measure different vessel populations over different windows. Reported side by side; never netted or averaged against one another.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	no reported moves in the last 24 hours
Knicks	no reported moves in the last 24 hours
Northwestern	no reported moves in the last 24 hours

LEAD

FED & OIL

A fraying Hormuz deal puts a hawkish Fed chair's first real test back on the table.

Brent added $0.84 to $84.39 and WTI $0.60 to $78.77 (~6:00a ET Mon), clawing back a sliver of last week's more-than-7% drop, after Iranian foreign minister Araghchi said Sunday that the Strait of Hormuz won't reopen until Washington eases sanctions and pays reparations — even as Tehran and Oman near a technical shipping-lane deal. The IRGC echoed the same conditionality Saturday. Prediction markets price a reopening by 8/15 at under 1%, by 8/31 at 4%, and by year-end at 48% — the diplomacy is inching forward on paper while the market treats an actual reopening as still more likely not to happen this year than to happen.

The Fed angle: Kevin Warsh — hawkish, Trump-picked, chair since May — faces his first real test. July's nonfarm payrolls print (-23,000 vs. +80,000 estimated) cut September rate-hike odds to roughly 44% from 67% a week earlier per CME FedWatch. That's hike odds falling, not cut odds rising — an unusual reaction given the jobs miss, and a sign markets are pricing Warsh's hawkishness as much as the data itself. Wednesday's CPI and Thursday's PPI are the next tests of that pricing, with oil's rebound this morning a live pass-through risk into the inflation prints before the Fed's next meeting.

Equities are largely shrugging it off — the S&P closed at a record 7,757.64 Friday, up 3.58% on the week, with Monday's futures roughly flat. But gold's 2.33% move and materials-sector leadership are diverging from that equity read, a gap worth watching into Wednesday's CPI: either the safe-haven bid unwinds as the Hormuz talk cools further, or equities are underpricing a stalled-diplomacy, sticky-oil scenario that gold is already leaning into.

POLITICS

No new votes since the House's war-powers resolution passed 214-208 in late July (four Republican crossovers: Barrett, Fitzpatrick, Davidson, Massie), with the Senate companion failing 47-49 — non-binding either way, and Trump has said he'd veto it. Warsh's May confirmation (54-45, only Fetterman crossing) and Powell's decision to stay on as a Fed governor with two years left on his term remain the backdrop to the Fed angle in the Lead; no new developments on either front to report.

BUSINESS

Alphabet's $25 billion, ten-tranche investment-grade bond sale (closed 8/6, ~$115 billion peak demand, third-largest order book of the year) continues to frame this earnings season's real story: 2026 capex guidance of $205 billion, more than double 2025's. Amazon, Meta and Oracle have collectively issued roughly $194 billion in IG debt through July, up 79% year-over-year — the AI buildout is increasingly debt-financed rather than cash-funded, a leverage point worth tracking into any rate-path surprise from Wednesday's CPI. Divergent earnings reactions continue: Shopify +17% on AI-driven traffic and order growth versus AMD -7% despite a beat-and-raise quarter, evidence the bar for "good enough" is rising. Roughly 226/174/186/291/51 companies report Monday through Friday this week (Yahoo Finance calendar).

TECHNOLOGY

No new prints since Friday. AMD's Q2 revenue was up 50% year-over-year to $11.5 billion with data-center revenue more than doubling, alongside its acquisition of a chip startup that hardwires AI models into silicon. Samsung and SK Hynix's zHBM and HBF memory architectures, aimed at the AI memory bottleneck, remain the read on where the next capacity constraint sits; SK Hynix has committed $38 billion to two new plants. Astera Labs' Q2 revenue was $392.4 million, up 104% year-over-year, on its Scorpio AI-connectivity switches. These are carried background from Friday's prints, included here only because they underpin the Business-section capex/financing read above; no new stock-specific catalysts today.

GEOPOLITICS

Houthis claimed an attack on a Saudi Aramco refinery Saturday 8/9 — Red Sea/Bab el-Mandeb theater, not the Strait itself, and single-sourced, unconfirmed independently as of press time. War background, for context: the conflict began February 28 with US/Israel strikes on Iran; Iran's Hormuz blockade followed March 4; a June 17 ceasefire memorandum of understanding collapsed July 8. Open-reporting tolls (not independently re-verified this run): 17 seafarers and one port worker killed; roughly 20,000 mariners and 2,000 ships stranded at the April peak. Brent peaked near $126 in March/April and remains well off that level even after this morning's bounce.

IRAN & HORMUZ

The Oman-Iran technical track has produced agreed shipping-lane coordinates and a proposed joint coordination center, but Iran ties an actual reopening to a separate list of conditions: an end to the naval blockade, a troop withdrawal, and compensation — the same conditionality repeated by Araghchi and the IRGC over the weekend, per the Lead. On insurance: Kpler's analysis notes premiums rise fast on individual attack headlines but decline only slowly through incident-free stretches, meaning normalization requires a sustained calm period rather than a single signed document — shipping and insurance costs are likely to stay elevated for some time even after any technical deal is signed.

SPORTS

Yankees	beat Braves 5-4 Sat 8/8 (Cole, 7 IP). 64-51, 3rd AL East.

Knicks	off-season, no game. Reigning 2026 NBA champions (beat Spurs 4-1, clinched 6/14).
Northwestern	off-season, no game. 2026 opener 9/5 vs. South Dakota State.

Continuity. Carried from issue No. 1 as established background, not re-reported as new: the Hormuz Day-162 closure baseline, the Houthi strikes on Aramco's Jazan refinery and Mokha port, the July jobs miss, and the AMD/Astera Labs Q2 prints (the last two appear today only insofar as they underpin the Business-section financing read). Dropped from full treatment: war-powers-vote roll-call detail and Warsh confirmation-vote detail beyond what the Lead's Fed angle requires; Knicks championship narrative will drop to the bare line starting next issue.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.